

THE CMY (WHITE) PAPER

The ZARO Artifact — A ZaroVerse Declaration

C + M + Y = WHITE

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The coin is a relic. The universe is the story.

The CMY (White) Paper — On the Name

This is a whitepaper. It is white.

In the CMY color model — the subtractive model that governs all physical printing — Cyan, Magenta, and Yellow combine to produce white. Not emptiness. Not absence. Completeness. The name is the proof.

$$\text{C} + \text{M} + \text{Y} = \text{WHITE}$$

Most whitepapers are white because they are blank. This one is white because $C + M + Y = \text{White}$. That is the lore.

The three colors carry distinct meaning within ZaroVerse:

- Cyan — the digital layer: the blockchain, the code, the transparent machine. Permanent. Immutable. Verifiable.
- Magenta — the creative layer: the stories, the characters, the universe. Emotional. Expansive. Human.
- Yellow — the explorer layer: the early believers, the curious, the ones who find things before they are obvious. Rare. Privileged. Ahead.

When all three are present — when the digital is real, the creative is alive, and the explorer has arrived — the result is white. Complete. Whole.

This document is the combination of all three. What follows is the full declaration of the ZARO artifact: what it is, how it was made, what it is becoming, and why it matters to those who find it now.

Part One — The Artifact

1. What is ZARO?

ZARO is a fixed-supply ERC-20 token deployed on Ethereum on June 29, 2025. One billion tokens. No more. Ever.

This is not a promise. It is a technical fact. The smart contract that governs ZARO has no mint function. Its ownership has been transferred to the zero address. No wallet, no company, no founder, no government, and no algorithm can create ZARO token number 1,000,000,001. The supply ceiling is enforced by mathematics and code — not by policy or the good intentions of a team.

Within the ZaroVerse narrative, ZARO's supply has a story: the mythical Giving Tree of ZaroVerse produces exactly one billion fruits before it rests, forever. The number is not arbitrary. It is the numerical expression of the lore — a deliberate alignment between the on-chain reality and the fictional world the token inhabits.

ZARO is not a currency. Not a utility token granting access to a platform. Not a governance token. Not a yield-bearing asset.

It is a collectible — the on-chain artifact of a fictional universe. Its relationship to ZaroVerse is the same as a physical collectible's relationship to the franchise it represents: it embodies the universe, it is scarce, and it is permanently real.

2. The Clean Launch

ZARO was launched on June 29, 2025, with the following properties — each executed on-chain and independently verifiable:

No Presale: No tokens were sold to investors at a discount before public availability. The first opportunity to acquire ZARO was through the open DEX market on Uniswap V2.

No Team Wallet: ZaroVerse Ltd. holds no privileged token allocation. In July 2025, the founder purchased 195,000,000 ZARO from the company treasury via an on-chain OTC transaction at the same per-token price as the public Uniswap pool — 3.9 ETH paid to the treasury wallet. Both legs of the transaction are independently verifiable on Etherscan. See Section 10 for the current supply state, which reflects the December 2025 incident and the buyback that followed.

No Venture Capital: ZARO received no venture capital investment. ZaroVerse Ltd. is self-funded by its founder. No VC holds ZARO at a discounted price waiting for a public listing to exit.

Permanently Locked Liquidity: The initial ETH/ZARO liquidity pool on Uniswap V2 (300,000,000 ZARO paired with 6 ETH) was locked for 255 years via UNCX Network on launch day. This lock is on-chain, irrevocable, and cryptographically enforced.

Renounced Contract: The contract owner address was transferred to the zero address (0x000...000) shortly after deployment. No minting, pausing, blacklisting, or configuration changes are possible by any party — ever.

Zero Tax: There is no buy tax, no sell tax, and no transfer fee. No mechanism exists to extract value from token transactions.

These properties are not claimed. They are documented in the public security repository:

<https://github.com/zarocoin/zarocoin/tree/main/docs/security>

Part Two — The Early Explorer

3. On Transparency and Early Discovery

We made a choice that most projects in this industry never make: we did not announce loudly. We did not pay key opinion leaders. We did not manufacture trading volume. We did not seek exchange listings before the foundation was solid.

We built the token correctly, transparently, and quietly — and we let it exist.

The token launched in what we call the project's 'garage phase': a single founder, a fully formed vision, a clean on-chain structure, and zero marketing expenditure. Every holder who found ZARO during this period did so on their own. Not because an algorithm served them an ad. Not because a paid influencer told them to. Not because a VC needed an exit.

We call the people who found ZARO in its early days the Early Explorers. In an industry where attention is manufactured and distributed by cash, the fact that you are reading this without having been sold to means something.

History is full of these moments — the early readers of a manuscript before it became a bestseller, the early visitors to an artist's first show before the retrospective, the early holders of a collectible before the franchise became a household name. Those people were not lucky. They were paying attention.

ZaroVerse Studios is now activating the full IP engine: published lore and books, merchandise, animated content, games, and a professional marketing operation. The project is transitioning from its quiet founding phase to its public operational phase. The early discovery window is not closed — but it is no longer invisible.

We do not promise that ZARO will be worth more tomorrow. We do not make financial projections. What we can say is this: everything we have built has been done with integrity, on-chain, verifiably, with no hidden moves. The structure is clean. The IP engine is starting to turn. And the people who found this before the world noticed will always be able to say they were here.

Part Three — The Universe

4. ZaroVerse

ZaroVerse is a multi-format fictional universe in active development and publication. It is the world that gives ZARO its meaning.

The universe was not built after the token to justify it retroactively. The token was issued as the artifact of a universe that was already in creative development. This is the distinction between a cultural collectible and a speculative instrument: the IP existed in the creator's vision before the token was deployed.

5. Characters and Lore

ZaroVerse is populated by original characters developed and copyright-registered by ZaroVerse Ltd.:

- Zaro — the central figure of the ZaroVerse universe. A symbol of curiosity, hope, and quiet mischief. Zaro exists across the lore's many chapters as a constant — a character who was always there, even before the audience arrived.
- ARC-7 — a mysterious AI entity from the early history of Ethereum. ARC-7 is a guardian archetype whose role in the ZaroVerse narrative bridges the digital and the mythological.
- More characters are being introduced as the lore expands across formats.

Original fiction in the ZaroVerse universe (Book 1: The Yellow Spark) has been written and copyright-registered. The lore is being published and distributed actively.

6. The Studios Model

ZaroVerse Studios — an operating arm of ZaroVerse Ltd. — is producing the following IP products across multiple formats:

Books and Written Lore: Original fiction set in the ZaroVerse universe, published and in ongoing distribution.

Merchandise: Plush toys, apparel, collectibles, and physical artifacts of the ZaroVerse universe currently in development, targeting Q2–Q3 2026 launch.

Games: Meme Wars — a casual game built around ZaroVerse characters — is in prototype development, targeting Q3 2026.

Animation: Short-form animated content connecting to the ZaroVerse lore, planned for Q4 2026.

Music: Original compositions tied to the ZaroVerse narrative are in production.

Social and Marketing: A professional social media and marketing operation is being activated with specialist support, moving from organic discovery into active audience development.

7. Intellectual Property

ZaroVerse Ltd. holds the following registered intellectual property:

- 9 USPTO trademark filings (all pending) covering: ZARO (word mark), ZARO (logo mark), ZARO (character/mascot), ZAROVERSE, MEMEWARS, ZAROVERSE MEMEWARS, ZaroLand, ARC-7, and related identifiers.
- US Copyright registration: ZARO character (visual and narrative identity), registered June 2025.
- US Copyright registration: ZaroVerse story/lore — Book 1: The Yellow Spark.

The IP model is designed for long-term licensing-first franchise development — comparable in structure and ambition to Hello Kitty (Sanrio), Minions (Universal), and Pudgy Penguins. As the IP reaches wider audiences through merchandise, media, and games, the artifact those audiences discover — ZARO — was on-chain before any of it was mainstream.

Part Four — Tokenomics

8. Token Specification

Name: Zaro Coin
Symbol: ZARO
Canonical Blockchain: Ethereum (ERC-20)
Total Supply: 1,000,000,000 ZARO (immutable hard cap)
Max Supply: 1,000,000,000 ZARO (same — no further issuance possible)
Decimals: 18
Transaction Tax: 0%
Mint Function: None
Pause Function: None
Blacklist Function: None
Upgrade Mechanism: None — non-upgradeable, non-proxy
Contract Owner: Zero address (renounced — permanent)
TGE Date: June 29, 2025
Standard: Thirdweb TokenERC20 / OpenZeppelin ERC-20

9. Contract Addresses

Ethereum (canonical, ERC-20):
`0xc311FD6DA9686507F33991543d8158EF5FaDd5E7`

BSC (Wormhole-bridged, BEP-20):
`0xa9D72F6C1490647DF20E8Fad3C136cA6AC42c2fc`

Solana (Wormhole-bridged, SPL):
`AbzXS6NfGvCtg5B1rqZ1JSfoDHkwTAeEYJkWkHhCe38W`

Base (Wormhole-bridged, ERC-20):
`0x1d4CeA73e212829d06B9a774d2e06be9DEe5AAB0`

10. Supply Distribution

Allocation	ZARO	%	Status
Permanently locked LP (Uniswap V2 ETH)	300,000,000	30.0%	Locked at launch via UNCX, 255 years. Cannot be withdrawn by anyone — including the

			founder.
Acquired through market-price transactions	~700,000,000	~70%	Held across many wallets. Every token paid for at the same per-token price publicly available on the Uniswap pool. Much was paid for again during the Dec 2025 buyback.
Team / VC / presale allocation	0	0%	None has ever existed.
Total	1,000,000,000	100%	Fixed supply — no mint function exists

There are no allocations. Every ZARO falls into one of two categories: 300,000,000 (30%) permanently locked in the Uniswap V2 ETH pool at launch (UNCX, 255 years — cannot be withdrawn by anyone, including the founder); and the remaining ~700,000,000 (~70%) held across many wallets, every wallet of which holds supply that was paid for at the same per-token price publicly available on the Uniswap pool. No team allocation. No VC allocation. No presale. No vesting schedule of any kind. None has ever existed.

The entire non-locked supply of ZARO has been paid for, in some cases twice.

History — December 2025 incident and buyback: In December 2025, a malware attack (alliai.us domain) drained the founder's wallet and a portion of the company treasury. The renounced contract held; no replacement tokens could be minted; total supply remained 1,000,000,000 throughout. The company executed a full buyback over December 2025 – February 2026, funded by the founder personally, via two parallel paths — Path 1: OTC settlements at original USD purchase price to every pre-incident buyer who registered; Path 2: open-market buyback through the public Uniswap pool. The supply that was stolen was reacquired. The founder's original 195M position, already paid for once at launch, was paid for again. Outside the 300M locked LP, every ZARO currently held by the company or the founder was paid for through capital deployed at market or original-buyer prices. Full chronology: <https://www.zarocoin.xyz/history> · Buyback record: <https://www.zarocoin.xyz/buyback>

11. Multi-Chain via Wormhole

ZARO's canonical contract on Ethereum is the source of truth for supply and ownership. All other chain deployments are bridged representations created via Wormhole — one of the most battle-tested cross-chain protocols in the ecosystem.

ETH LP (Uniswap V2): Locked 255 years via UNCX. TX:

<https://etherscan.io/tx/0xbb17a0d05a167047fb478c9769badaed00fa40e964a54d2917181420d26f4581>

BSC LP (PancakeSwap V2): Active.

Solana LP (Meteora DLMM): Permanently locked via Meteora. Irrevocable.

Base LP (Uniswap v3 ZARO/USDC + Aerodrome fallback): Primary low-cost trading rail (Uniswap v3 ZARO/USDC 0.01%). Aerodrome ZARO/WETH fallback pool: LP permanently burned to 0xdead. Burn TX:
<https://basescan.org/tx/0x2033eda615044458b723fb9b7a2141ddcd6cc60d5bf9c7cde933c8d2e33da332>

12. Data Listings

ZARO is listed on CoinGecko and CoinMarketCap across all four chains:

CoinGecko: <https://www.coingecko.com/en/coins/zaro-coin>

CoinMarketCap: <https://coinmarketcap.com/currencies/zaro-coin/>

Part Five — Legal Classification

ZaroVerse Ltd. is committed to full regulatory transparency. This section addresses the legal classification of ZARO and is provided to assist exchanges, regulators, and holders in understanding the nature of the token.

13. ZARO is a Collectible, Not a Security

ZARO is classified as a cultural collectible token — specifically, as the on-chain artifact of the ZaroVerse fictional universe. It is not a financial security, an investment contract, a share of equity, or a debt instrument.

ZaroVerse Ltd. holds a formal legal opinion issued by Drew Barnholtz, Esq., The Barnholtz Law Firm, LLC (October 7, 2025), which analyzes ZARO under six international regulatory frameworks and concludes that ZARO is NOT a security. The opinion includes a full four-prong US Howey Test analysis.

The public version of the legal opinion is available at:

<https://github.com/zarocoin/zarocoin/tree/main/docs/legal>

14. The Howey Test Analysis

Under the US Supreme Court's Howey Test (SEC v. W.J. Howey Co., 1946), an instrument constitutes an investment contract — and therefore a security — if it involves: (1) an investment of money, (2) in a common enterprise, (3) with an expectation of profits, (4) primarily from the efforts of others. We analyze each prong:

Prong 1 — Investment of Money: ZARO was not sold through any investment contract, ICO, or private sale. It became available through open DEX trading — the same mechanism through which anyone purchases any commodity, collectible, or fungible asset on a public market. Purchasers did not enter into any agreement with ZaroVerse Ltd.

Prong 2 — Common Enterprise: The ZARO contract is renounced. ZaroVerse Ltd. does not control the token supply, the contract behavior, or the liquidity (which is permanently locked or burned). There is no pooling of purchaser funds toward a common enterprise controlled by an issuer. The 'enterprise,' if any, is the open market itself.

Prong 3 — Expectation of Profits: ZARO is explicitly positioned as a cultural collectible — not an investment product. No yield, staking rewards, dividends, or profit expectations are offered or promised anywhere in this document or in any official ZaroVerse communication. Cultural appreciation of an artifact is not the same as an investment expectation under securities law.

Prong 4 — Efforts of Others (the critical prong): Post-renouncement, the owner of the ZARO contract is the zero address. No entity — including ZaroVerse Ltd. — can affect the

token's supply, transaction rules, or on-chain behavior. ZaroVerse Ltd. is a participant in the same ecosystem as any token holder: a community member, not a controller. The fourth prong — the most important prong — does not apply to ZARO after renouncement.

15. The Bitcoin Analogy

When any exchange lists Bitcoin, no one contacts Satoshi Nakamoto for permission. Bitcoin has no controlling party. Any exchange listing Bitcoin is listing a public smart contract whose behavior is governed entirely by its code — not by a person, a team, or a company.

ZARO, after renouncement, is in the same structural position. The contract owner is the zero address. No entity controls the supply or behavior of ZARO. An exchange listing ZARO is listing a public smart contract — not a company-issued security.

16. Jurisdiction

ZARO is a permissionless public smart contract. The contract is accessible globally. The company does not sell ZARO; trading occurs only via third-party decentralized exchanges. Users are individually responsible for compliance with applicable laws in their jurisdiction.

The ZARO smart contract owner is the zero address. ZaroVerse Ltd. does not sell ZARO to anyone. There is no issuer–buyer relationship.

The contract is fully renounced. No person or entity controls the contract, the supply, or the liquidity post-renouncement.

The primary ETH/ZARO liquidity pool is locked for 255 years via UNCX, enforced on-chain. No party can remove this liquidity.

ZaroVerse Ltd. maintains an operational presence in the UAE (Dubai, License No. 1554666). The company does not restrict access to ZARO by geography. Holders in all jurisdictions are individually responsible for their own compliance with applicable local laws and regulations.

A formal standalone US Howey opinion has not yet been commissioned. ZaroVerse Ltd. holds a BVI legal opinion (October 2025) issued by Drew Barnholtz, Esq., which includes a comparative Howey analysis. ZaroVerse Ltd. is committed to full legal transparency.

Part Six — Security and Technical Integrity

17. Smart Contract

The ZARO smart contract is based on Thirdweb's TokenERC20 implementation — itself built on OpenZeppelin's ERC-20 standard, the most widely audited token implementation in the Ethereum ecosystem.

Contract standard: Thirdweb TokenERC20 / OpenZeppelin ERC-20

Audit: Thirdweb Smart Contract Audit — audit-12.pdf (public)

Ownership: Renounced — zero address. Permanent and irreversible.

Mint function: None — supply is fixed at deployment and cannot increase

Pause function: None

Blacklist function: None

Upgrade mechanism: None — non-upgradeable, non-proxy

Tax mechanism: None — 0% on all transactions

Audit report (public):

<https://github.com/thirdweb-dev/contracts/blob/main/audit-reports/audit-12.pdf>

18. Security Scan — Blockaid

ZARO has been reviewed by Blockaid, the leading web3 security provider used by MetaMask, Coinbase Wallet, Phantom, and major exchanges globally. ZARO is confirmed clean across all four chains with no malicious flags of any kind.

19. Liquidity Security

The ZARO liquidity layer is secured at the smart contract level, not by policy:

ETH LP — 255-year lock:

Lock TX: 0xbb17a0d05a167047fb478c9769badaed00fa40e964a54d2917181420d26f4581

<https://etherscan.io/tx/0xbb17a0d05a167047fb478c9769badaed00fa40e964a54d2917181420d26f4581>

Base LP — permanently burned:

Burn TX: 0x2033eda615044458b723fb9b7a2141ddcd6cc60d5bf9c7cde933c8d2e33da332

<https://basescan.org/tx/0x2033eda615044458b723fb9b7a2141ddcd6cc60d5bf9c7cde933c8d2e33da332>

Solana LP — permanently locked:

Locked via Meteora DLMM's irrevocable lock mechanism.

20. Security Documentation

Full per-chain security documentation, contract verification, transparency reports, and security profiles are publicly available:

<https://github.com/zarocoin/zarocoin/tree/main/docs/security>

Verified contract block explorers:

Ethereum:

<https://etherscan.io/token/0xc311FD6DA9686507F33991543d8158EF5FaDd5E7>

BSC:

<https://bscscan.com/token/0xa9D72F6C1490647DF20E8Fad3C136cA6AC42c2fc>

Solana:

<https://solscan.io/token/AbzXS6NfGvCtg5B1rqZ1JSfoDHkwTAeEYJkWkHhCe38W>

Base:

<https://basescan.org/token/0x1d4CeA73e212829d06B9a774d2e06be9DEe5AAB0>

Part Seven — The Road Ahead

ZARO, as a fixed-supply collectible on a renounced and immutable contract, does not have a traditional development roadmap. The token is complete. Its supply, contract, and liquidity are permanently set. Nothing about ZARO itself will change.

What follows is the roadmap of the ZaroVerse ecosystem: the creative IP, the stories, the products, and the universe that gives ZARO its meaning and context. This roadmap belongs to ZaroVerse — not to the token.

ZaroVerse Ltd. functions as the steward and custodian of the ZaroVerse intellectual property. The company's role is to build and protect the universe. It does not develop, manage, or control the token in any way — the contract is fully renounced and immutable.

As the ZaroVerse ecosystem grows, the company will consider whether a utility dimension can be authentically introduced for ZARO, in a manner consistent with the lore. This is not a plan. No utility has been designed, announced, or committed to, and no timeline is given. No price outcome is implied or suggested. The token today is what it was on June 29, 2025: the canonical collectible artifact of the ZaroVerse universe.

21. ZaroVerse Ecosystem Roadmap

Q2–Q3 2026

- First centralized exchange listing(s) — applications submitted to major global exchanges
- Merchandise launch: plush toys, apparel, and collectible physical artifacts
- Social media and marketing activation — ZaroVerse Studios marketing engine live
- Expanded lore publishing and story releases

Q3–Q4 2026

- Meme Wars game — prototype and early public release
- Animated short-form content for social media and streaming platforms
- Music releases connected to the ZaroVerse narrative

2027 and Beyond

- Global IP licensing partnerships — brand collaborations, media deals
- ZaroVerse institutional and media partnerships
- Physical and digital merchandise expansion
- ZaroLand — a long-term experiential and theme park concept under development

Part Eight — The Team

22. Founder

ZARO and ZaroVerse were built by a single founder. This was a deliberate choice: to build something real before building a team around it — to have the substance precede the structure.

Name: Shihab Khalil

Role: Founder & CEO, ZaroVerse Ltd.

Education: Software & Computer Engineering (Wright State University, 1998) | MBA (New York Institute of Technology, 2004) | LLM — International Law & Global Leadership (2011)

Other company: Founder & CEO, ZagTrader (est. 2008) — a multi-asset trading platform providing OMS/EMS, risk, compliance, and market data solutions to banks, brokers, and exchanges globally.

LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/shihab>

Twitter/X: <https://x.com/shihabkhalil>

23. Company

Legal entity: ZaroVerse Ltd.

Incorporation date: August 1, 2025

UAE presence: Dubai, UAE (License No. 1554666)

Website: <https://www.zaroverse.com>

Contact: core@zaroverse.com

Funding: Self-funded — no external investors, no venture capital, no fundraising rounds

Part Nine — The Invitation

Most documents like this one end with a call to action: 'Buy our token.' 'Join our community.' 'Don't miss out.'

This is not that.

We are not trying to sell you anything. The contract is renounced — we cannot benefit from new issuance. The liquidity is locked — we cannot pull it. The supply is fixed — there is no printing press.

What we are saying is simpler: ZaroVerse is being built. The IP engine is beginning to turn. The token that was placed on Ethereum on June 29, 2025 — quietly, without fanfare, without paid promoters, without a manufactured listing — is the artifact of what is being built.

Whether you are a holder who found ZARO before you read this document, or someone encountering it for the first time — you are in the early chapter of a story that has not yet been told to most people. Not the last chapter. The early one.

The Giving Tree has already produced its fruits. All one billion of them. They are on Ethereum, on BSC, on Solana, on Base. They will never produce more. The tree is at rest.

What happens next is the story of what those fruits become. That story is being written.

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— ZaroVerse Studios
May 2026

References and Links

Token Website: <https://www.zarocoin.xyz>

ZaroVerse Universe: <https://www.zaroverse.com>

GitHub Repository: <https://github.com/zarocoin/zarocoin>

Whitepaper (this doc): <https://github.com/zarocoin/zarocoin/blob/main/docs/whitepaper/>

Security Documentation: <https://github.com/zarocoin/zarocoin/tree/main/docs/security>

Legal Opinion (public): <https://github.com/zarocoin/zarocoin/tree/main/docs/legal>

Trademarks (public): <https://github.com/zarocoin/zarocoin/tree/main/docs/trademarks>

Audit Report: <https://github.com/thirdweb-dev/contracts/blob/main/audit-reports/audit-12.pdf>

CoinGecko: <https://www.coingecko.com/en/coins/zaro-coin>

CoinMarketCap: <https://coinmarketcap.com/currencies/zaro-coin/>

DexScreener (ETH):

<https://dexscreener.com/ethereum/0x53085839a2ee860e58108665825fc7ef5e061213>

Twitter/X: <https://x.com/zaroproject>

Telegram: <https://t.me/zaroprojectofficial>

Instagram: <https://www.instagram.com/zaroproject>

TikTok: <https://www.tiktok.com/@zaroproject>

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